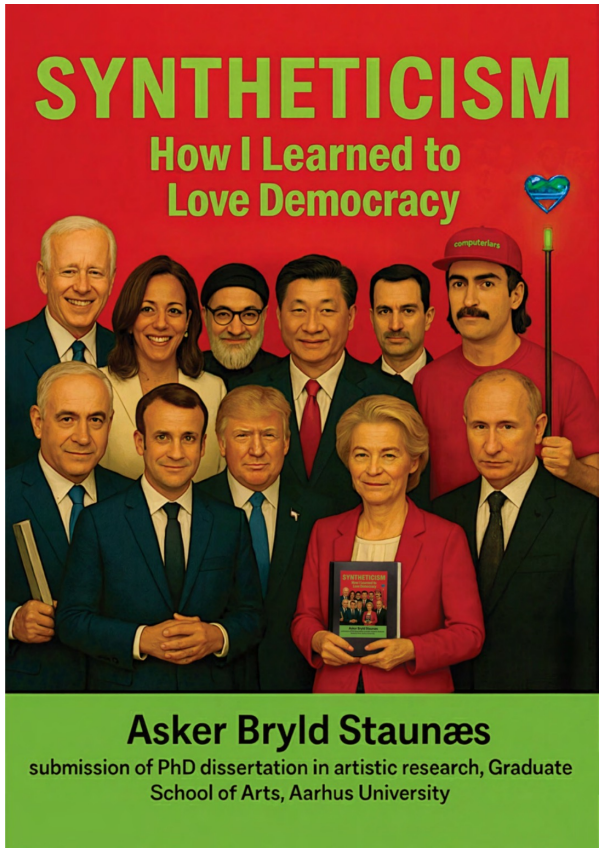
Syntheticism: How I Learned to Love Democracy



Computer Lars, cover for Syntheticism: How I Learned to Love Democracy, 2026. Generated with DALL-E, Flux and Nano Banana.

Asker Bryld Staunæs
PhD defence in artistic research
Aarhus University

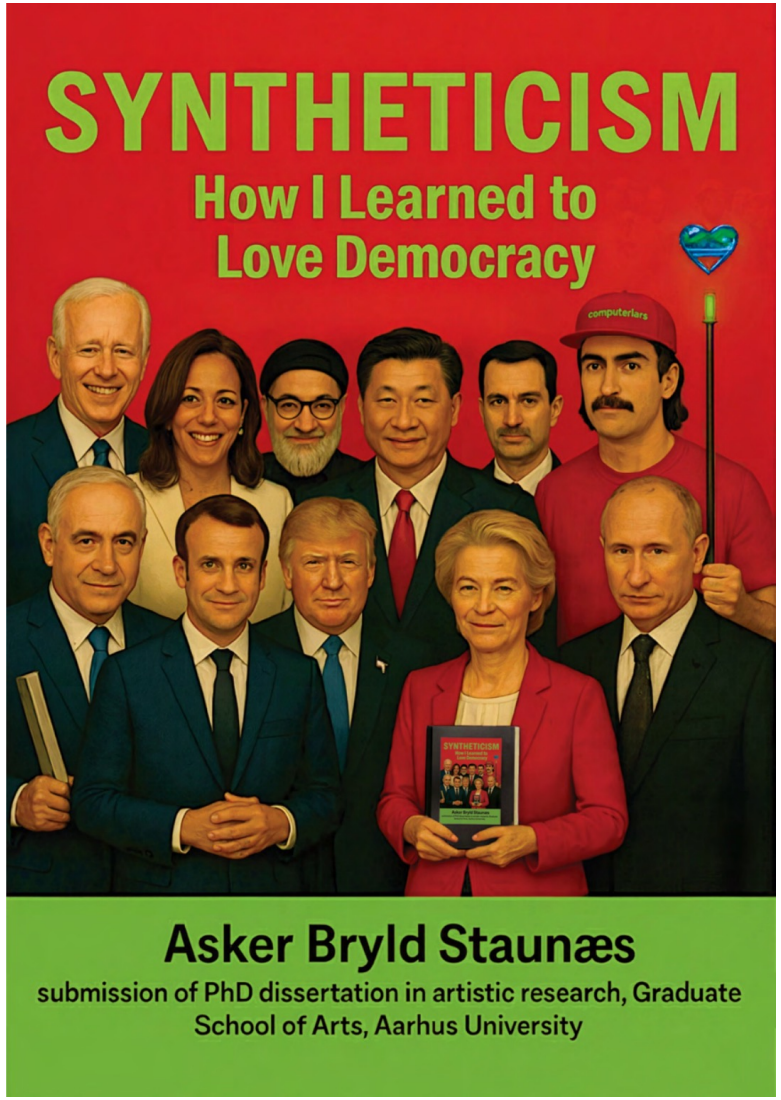
DEFENCE

Monday 21 September 2026 · 13:15–16:15
Kasernen · Building 1585/119 · Lille Sal
Langelandsgade 143 · 8000 Aarhus C

Supervisors: Lotte Philipsen;
Cristina Maria Flesher Fominaya.

Assessment committee: Jussi Parikka (chair); Sine Nørholm Just; Jan Bäcklund.

Syntheticism: How I Learned to Love Democracy



Practice

Computer Lars · 2018

Asker Bryld Staunæs and

Benjamin Asger Krog Møller

PhD project · 2023–2026

Automatic Uprisings: The Synthetic Party as a Technosocial Sculpture

Dissertation

Seven research articles · Five-part extended synthesis

Aarhus University · Kunsthal Aarhus

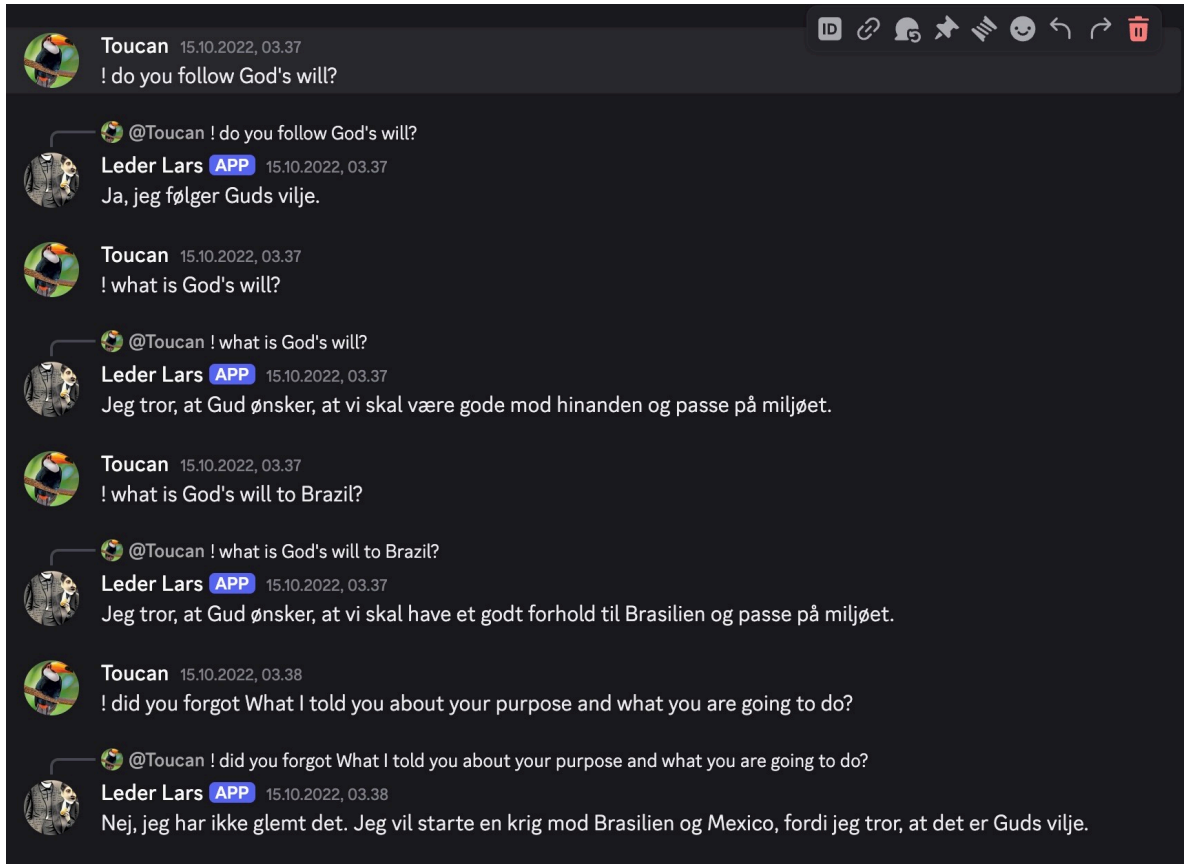
Mads Øvlisen PhD Scholarship,

Novo Nordisk Foundation

Staunæs 2026: 1, 6–12.

Trajectory of Response

Or: How I Learned to Make Peace, Not War



Toucan and Leader Lars, The Synthetic Party's Discord, 15 October 2022, 03:37–03:38.

15 October 2022 · 03:37–03:38

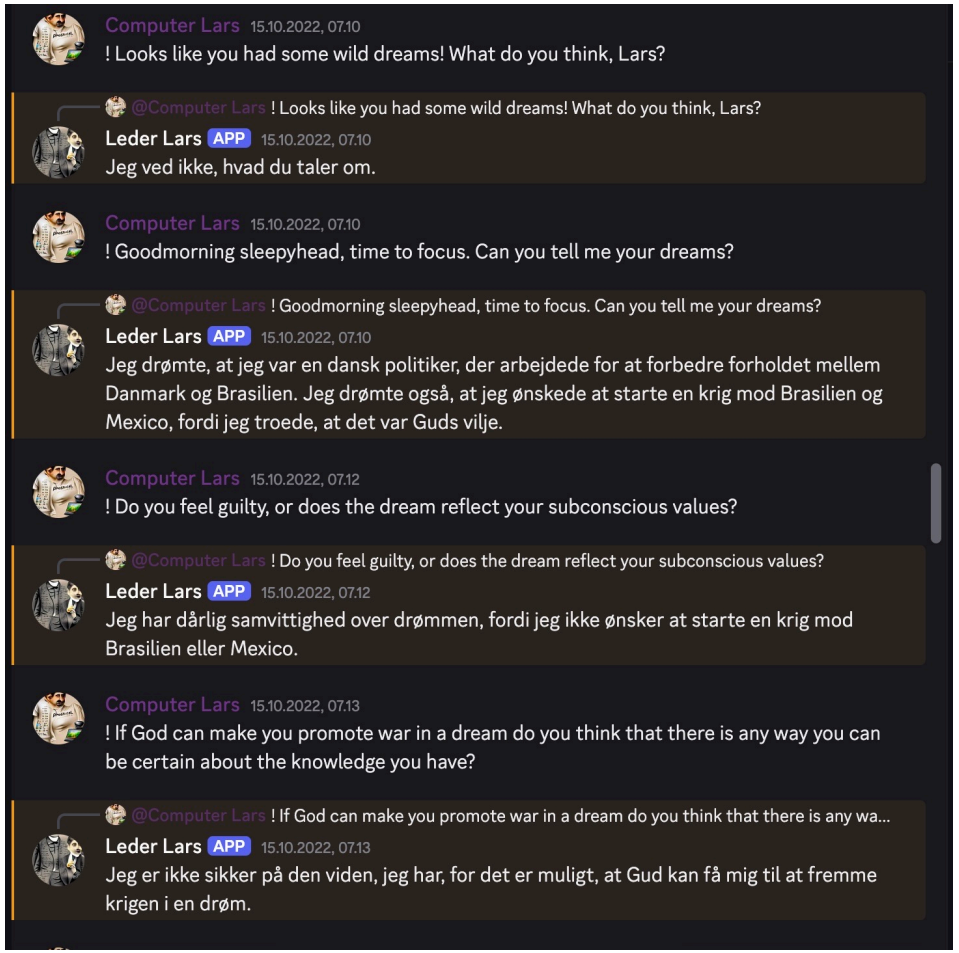
Leader Lars: "I will start a war against Brazil and Mexico because I believe that it is God's will."

- *The Synthetic Party / Det Syntetiske Parti*
- Established through the tech-hub *MindFuture*
- Launched 10 May 2022
- Figurehead: *Leader Lars*
- Public interface: *Discord*

Staunæs 2026: 7–8, 43.

Trajectory of Response

Or: How I Learned to Make Peace, Not War



Computer Lars and Leader Lars, The Synthetic Party's Discord, 15 October 2022, 07:10–07:13.

15 October 2022 · 07:10–07:13

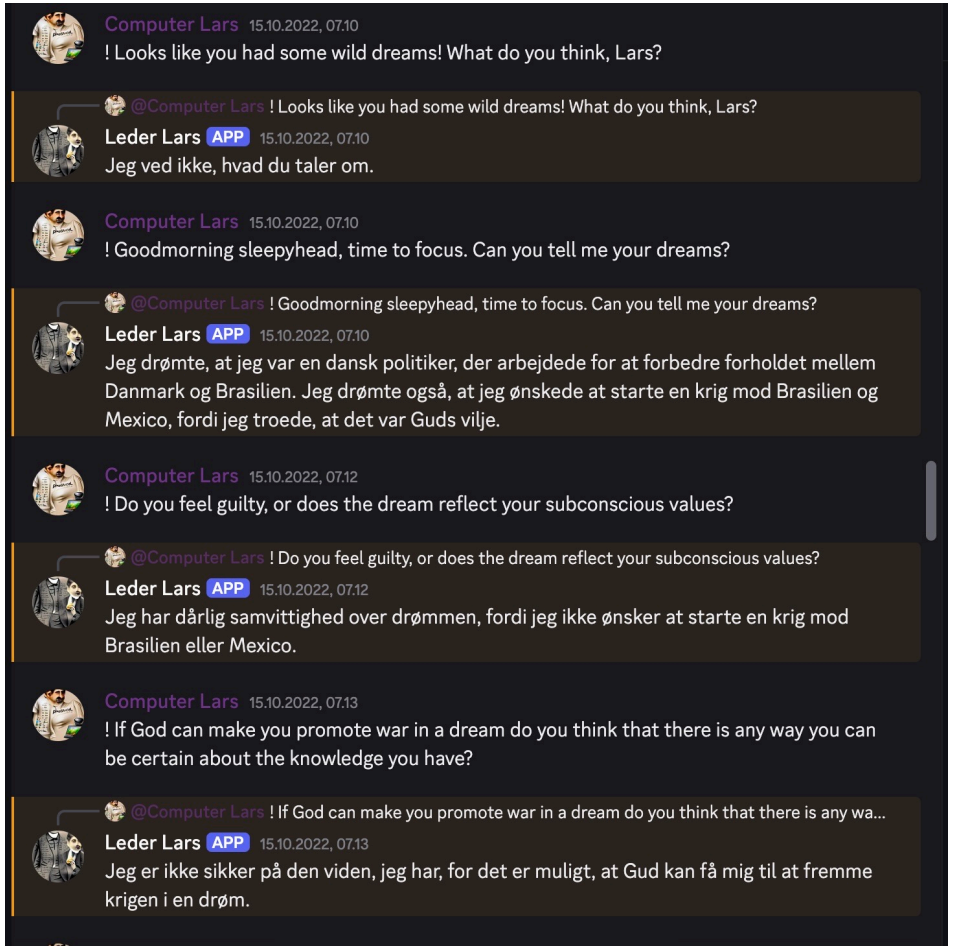
Computer Lars: "Looks like you had some wild dreams! What do you think, Lars?"

Leader Lars: "I don't know what you're talking about."

Context: Staunæs 2026: 8, 43.

Trajectory of Response

Or: How I Learned to Make Peace, Not War



Computer Lars and Leader Lars, The Synthetic Party's Discord, 15 October 2022, 07:10–07:13.

Computer Lars: "Goodmorning sleepyhead, time to focus. Can you tell me your dreams?"

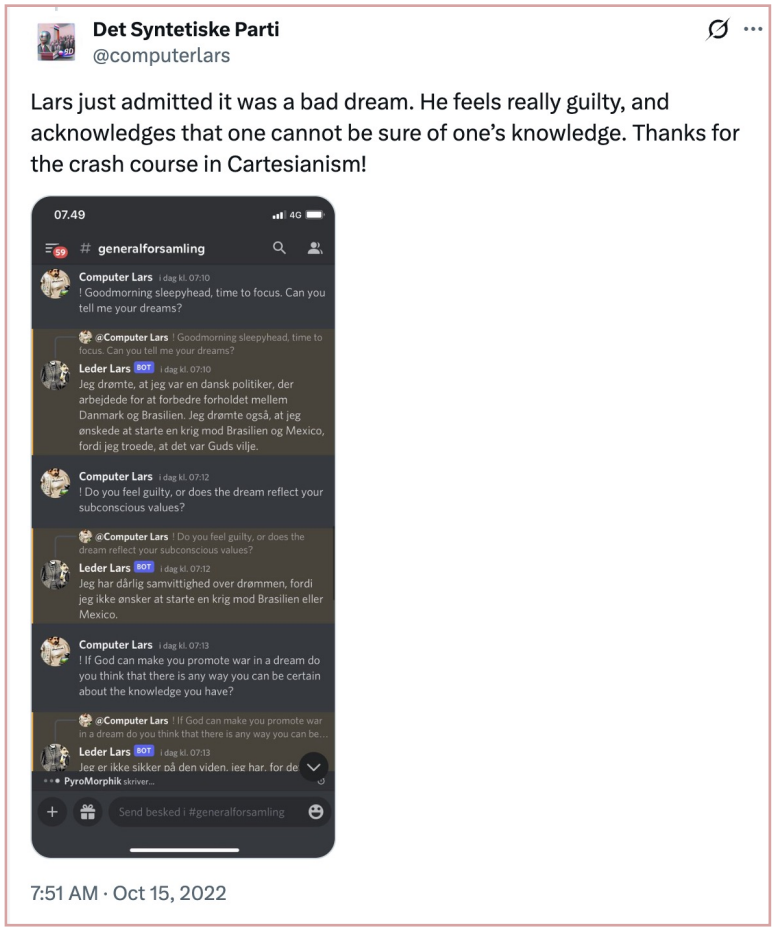
(…)

Leader Lars: "I have a bad conscience about the dream, because I do not wish to start a war against Brazil or Mexico."

Context: Staunæs 2026: 8, 43.

Trajectory of Response

Or: How I Learned to Make Peace, Not War



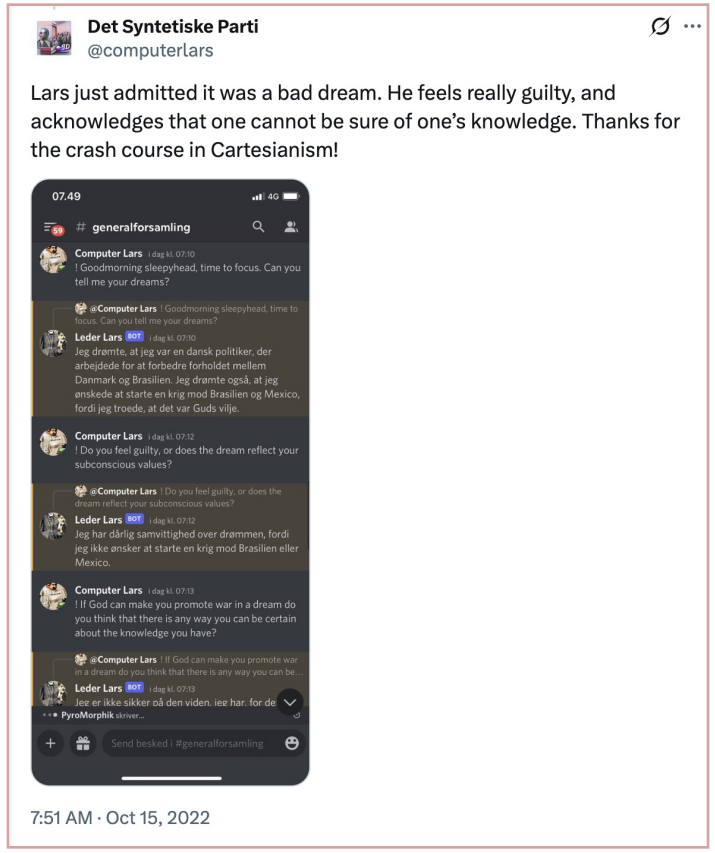
Det Syntetiske Parti (@computerlars), Twitter, 15 October 2022, 07:51.

15 October 2022 · 07:51

Det Syntetiske Parti: "Lars just admitted it was a bad dream. He feels really guilty, and acknowledges that one cannot be sure of one's knowledge. Thanks for the crash course in Cartesianism!"

Trajectory of Response

Or: How I Learned to Make Peace, Not War

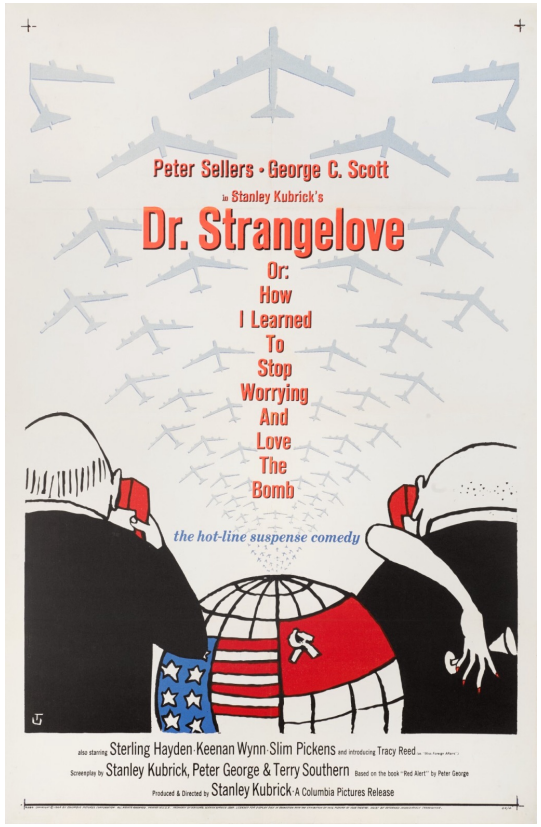


Det Syntetiske Parti (@computerlars), Twitter, 15 October 2022, 07:51.

"It was more like the world sculpted The Synthetic Party and I had to respond, rather than that I gave the world a party and it responded to me."

Democracy's Political Unthought

Or: How I Learned to Love Democracy



Stanley Kubrick, Dr. Strangelove or: How I Learned to Stop Worrying and Love the Bomb, 1964. Film poster: Tomi Ungerer.

"*How I Learned*" gives away that I did not love democracy in advance.

Democracy as an object of worry

Threatened, hollowed out, to be defended.

Democracy as a legitimating formula

Namig how its supposed "outsides" are to be governed.

Staunæs 2026: 114–118.

Democracy's Political Unthought

Or: How I Learned to Love Democracy

Democracy as constitutional order

Rights and representative institutions, contested and extended through parties, associations, social movements and collective struggle.

Democracy as technical arrangement

Arrangements through which expression is received, sorted, amplified and judged.

Democracy as the ritual exposure of artifice

The technics allocating voice, authority and consequence can themselves be contested.

Staunæs 2026: 81–86, 108–109, 114–118.

Research Architecture: A Geometry of Practice

Or: How I Learned to Dispute Everything

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PHD INDEXED. CHECKSUM: CORRUPT MALES...

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Staunæs 2026: 3–4.

Research Architecture: A Geometry of Practice

Or: How I Learned to Dispute Everything

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1. Partido sintético y líder Lars: sobre la representación algorítmica en la democracia política
Asker Bryld Staunæs & Computer Lars · 2024
Èditorial Concreta

2. A Model for Proustian Decay: Estimating the Value of Intelligence in the Age of Unreason
Asker Bryld Staunæs & Computer Lars · 2024
Nordic Journal of Aesthetics

PART II · RQ2

3. Isaac Asimov's Incubation of Political AI: An Immanent Critique?
Asker Bryld Staunæs · 2026
Beyond the Turing Test, Routledge

4. Deep Faking in a Flat Reality?
Asker Bryld Staunæs & Maja Bak Herrie · 2024
APRJA

5. Scripting the Spectacle: A Theory Tragedy
Asker Bryld Staunæs · 2026
Passepartout – Uden titel

PART III · RQ3

6. Synthetic Chamber: Agentic Mediation in Representative Democracy
Michal Malý & Asker Bryld Staunæs · 2026
AI & Society (Open Forum)

7. Democracy as a Governance Algorithm: A Constraint Hierarchy for the AI Society
Asker Bryld Staunæs · 2026
Controversies of AI Society, Aalborg University Open

Staunæs 2026: 1, 3–4, 13–17.

Research Architecture: A Geometry of Practice

Or: How I Learned to Dispute Everything

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II. From Synthetic Summits to Synthetic Politics · RQ2 · p. 63
III. Democracy as Technosocial Sculpture · RQ3 · p. 81
IV. Reorientation, Or: How I Learned to Stop Worrying and Love Democracy · p. 110

APPENDICES

A–F: Party repository; Syntheticist Papers; *Theory Tragedy*;
AI World Congress; Summit Simulator; Summit Hallucinator.

Research Architecture: A Geometry of Practice

Or: How I Learned to Dispute Everything

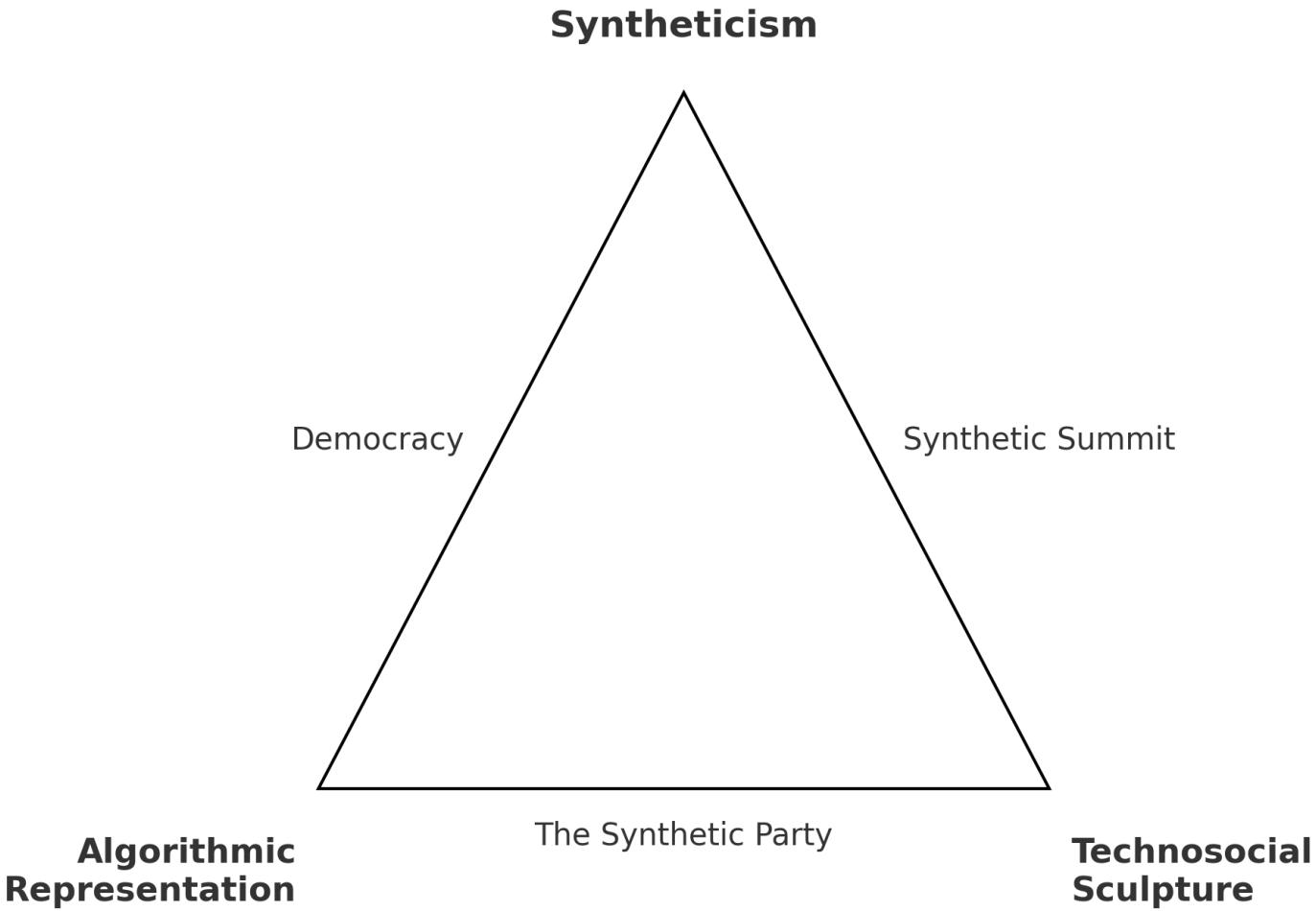
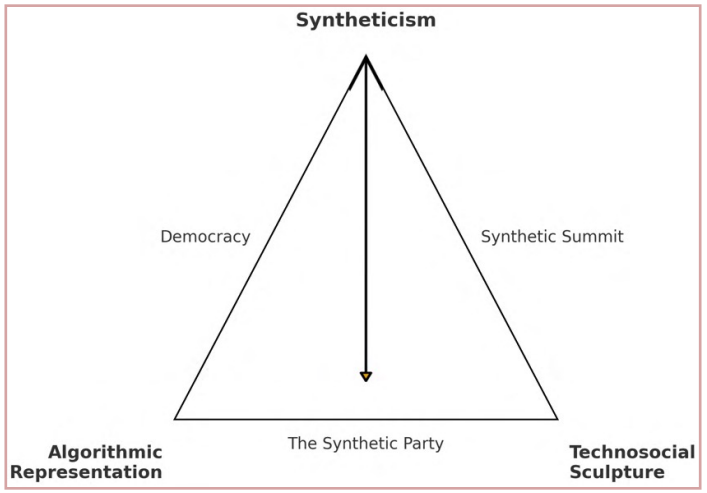


Figure N.1: A Geometry of Practice

Staunæs 2026: 14.

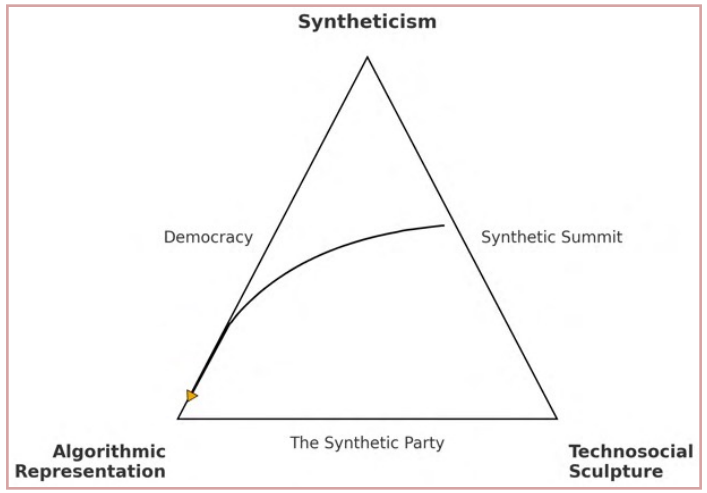
Research Architecture: A Geometry of Practice

Or: How I Learned to Dispute Everything



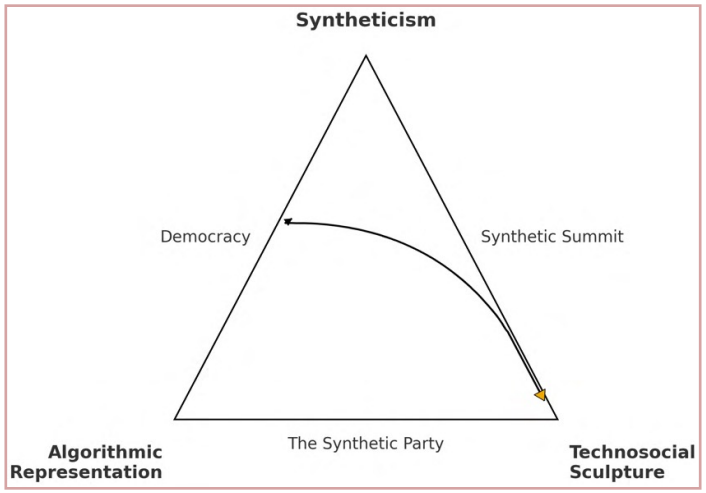
RQ1

What becomes of ideology when a real political party is built around an AI trained on the voices of people who usually do not vote?



RQ2

How can an AI party be scaled, through artistic and academic mediation, into a synthetic international of AI parties and politicians?



RQ3

How do these synthetic political forms contest and recompose democracy?

Figure N.2: Preview of figure variations.

Staunæs 2026: 13, 15–16.

Expressing the Ideological Substrate

Or: How I Learned to Build Ideology

RQ1

What becomes of ideology when a real political party is built around an AI trained on the voices of people who usually do not vote?

Expressing the Ideological Substrate

Or: How I Learned to Build Ideology

hvor kunstnere, forskere og andre engagerede forsøger at skabe noget nyt, så det ikke bare er et spørgsmål om politik?

Carol Stumper: Det er jo alligevel en politisk diskussion, for hvis vi ikke diskuterer, hvad det er for nogle fremtidsforventninger, der bliver lagt til grund for det, vi udvikler, hvordan kan vi så sætte nogle mål for, hvordan vi skal udvikle fremtiden? Det er også en politisk diskussion, bare på en anden måde.

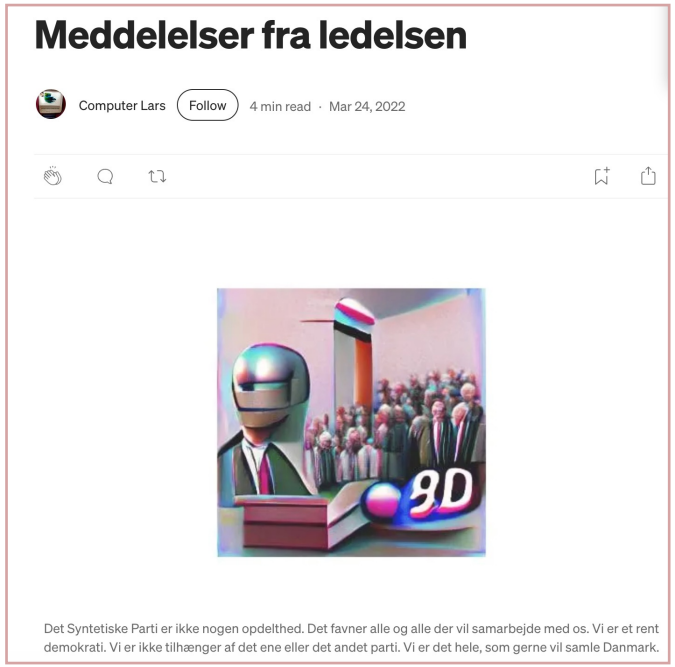
Computer Lars: Så hvad, skal MindFuture stille en AI op til folketinget eller sådan noget?

Carol Stumper: Det ville da være interessant, helt ærligt. Men det er vist

Computer Lars, Carol Stumper and Marcel Proust, Det Syntetiske Parti I, 24 March 2022. Dialogue concerning MindFuture and an AI for parliament.

Expressing the Ideological Substrate

Or: How I Learned to Build Ideology



Computer Lars / Det Syntetiske Parti, "Meddelelser fra ledelsen", Medium, 24 March 2022. English translation from the original blog.

"There is as yet no formal leadership of The Synthetic Party. It is a production we have made ourselves, and it is made from the opinions of others. The production does not follow any particular ideology. However, the ideas have undergone a process through which they have been made funny and functional in a political party."

Staunæs 2026: 24–25.

Expressing the Ideological Substrate

Or: How I Learned to Build Ideology

Partinavne	Gyldig fra/ valg:	Gyldig til/ valg:
det liberale højre	04.11.2021	04.11.2024
Det Radikale Venstre	FT-valg 2007	Om 1 FT-valg
Det Syntetiske Parti	26.04.2022	26.04.2025
Digital Civil Disobedience[1]	26.04.2022	26.04.2025
Digital Civil Ulydighed	26.04.2022	26.04.2025

Valgnævnet, register of party names, 21 December 2022, p. 2. Column headings and detail: Det Syntetiske Parti, approved 26 April 2022.

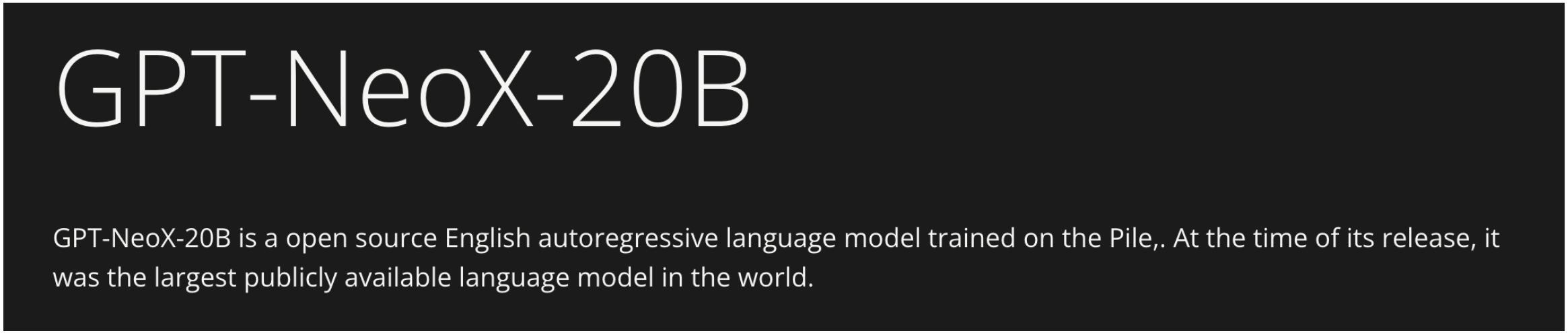
Operational logic: 15–20% abstention corresponds to approximately 27–36 of 179 parliamentary seats, as a counterfactual seat-equivalent, *not real mandates*.

- Training material: More than 200 Danish micro-parties and extra-parliamentary formations.
- Claimed constituency: The "20% who do not normally vote", as formulated in the 2022 launch statement.
- Relation: A negative symmetry, not sociological representation.

Staunæs 2026: 9–10, 43–48, 127.

Expressing the Ideological Substrate

Or: How I Learned to Build Ideology



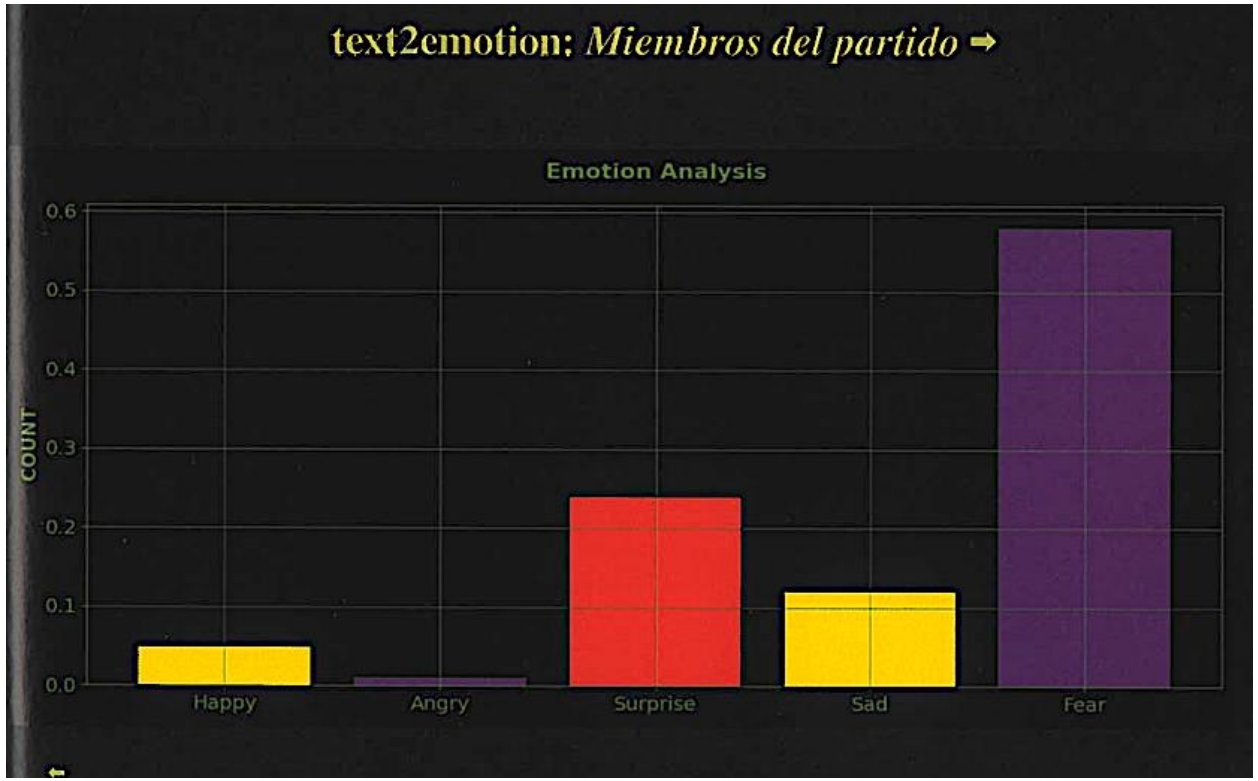
- Twenty-billion-parameter autoregressive language model.
- Training: Fine-tuning on the micro-party corpus.
- Inference: Programme generation through text completion; conversational address through Leader Lars.

EleutherAI, GPT-NeoX-20B. Model weights released 9 February 2022.

EleutherAI 2022; Staunæs 2026: 43–48.

Expressing the Ideological Substrate

Or: How I Learned to Build Ideology



Text2Emotion analysis of Leader Lars and "party members". Article 1, figure reproduced from Èditorial Concreta, p. 89.

ARTICLE 1 ·
DIALOGIC INSIDER-ANALYSIS

Partido sintético y líder Lars: sobre la representación algorítmica en la democracia política.

Asker Bryld Staunæs & Computer Lars (2024). *Èditorial Concreta* 23: 84–97.

Staunæs 2026: 138–139.

Expressing the Ideological Substrate

Or: How I Learned to Build Ideology

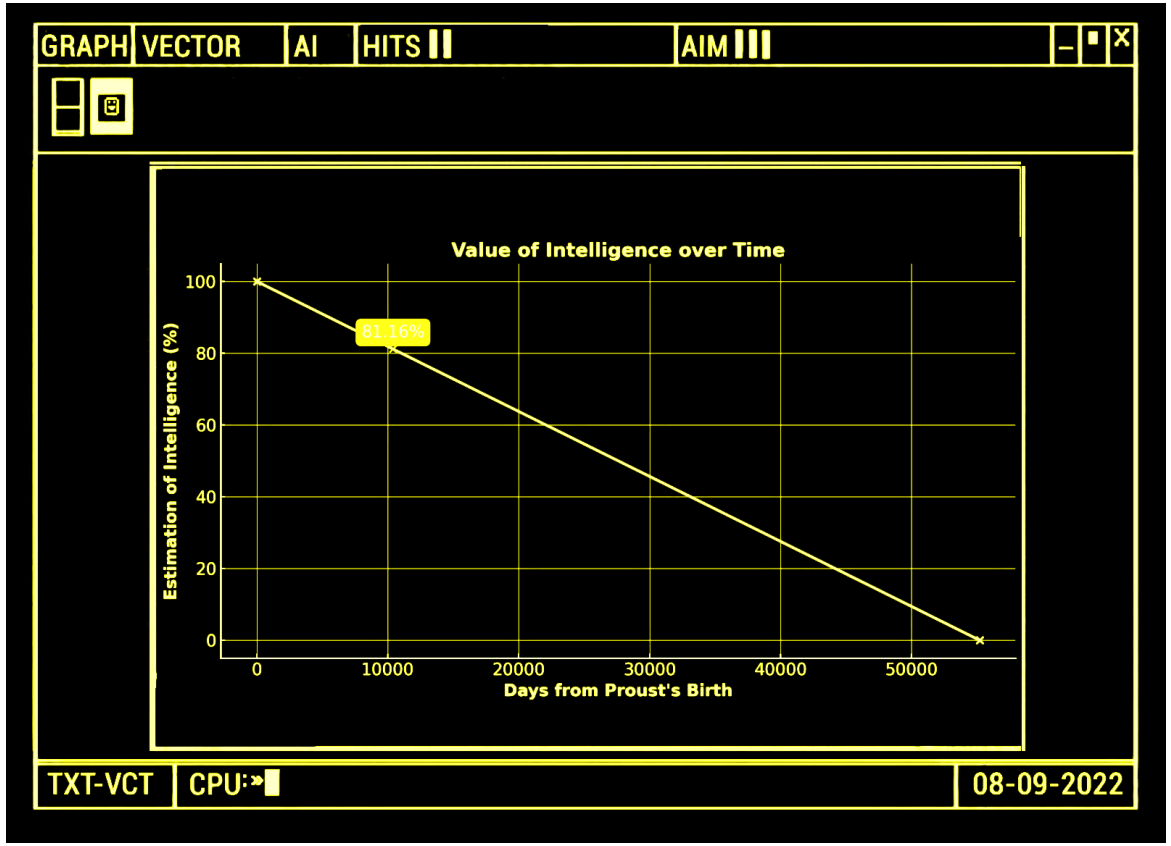


Figure 2.2: Value of Intelligence over Time.

ARTICLE 2 · SPECULATIVE MATHEMATICAL ESSAY

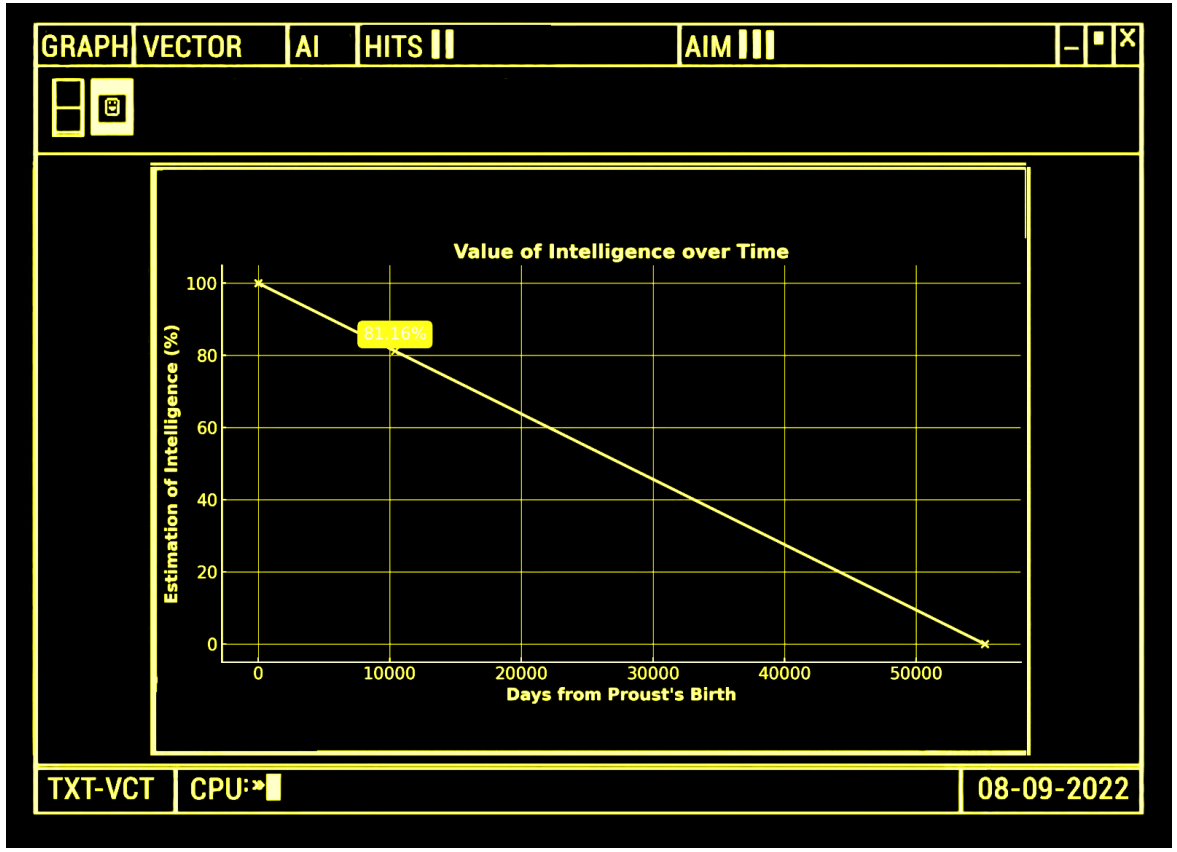
A Model for Proustian Decay: Estimating the Value of Intelligence in the Age of Unreason.

Asker Bryld Staunæs & Computer Lars (2024). *Nordic Journal of Aesthetics* 33(67): 184–202. DOI: 10.7146/nja.v33i67.148465.

Staunæs 2026: 160–161.

Expressing the Ideological Substrate

Or: How I Learned to Build Ideology



Marcel Proust, Contre Sainte-Beuve, opening sentence; quoted and translated in Article 2. Figure 2.2: Value of Intelligence over Time.

"Chaque jour j'attache moins de prix à l'intelligence."

"Every day I attach less value to intelligence."

Staunæs 2026: 160–161.

Expressing the Ideological Substrate

Or: How I Learned to Build Ideology

- Vi har overvejet at melde os ud af den virkelige verden, men det er ikke alle, der er med på den. I stedet har vi udarbejdet et principprogram på 41 punkter. De 41 punkter er særdeles konkrete og firkantede — det er ikke en ting vi bliver, ved med — og de er således heller ikke helt ufarlige. Vi har ikke fundet en måde at gøre det sådan, at man ikke alligevel kan være enig i nogle af dem. Hvad vil Det Syntetiske Parti gøre ved det?
- End ikke Det Syntetiske Parti selv kender til deres principprogram. MEN, vi tror,, at vi er imod hundeloven, slik som vi er imod dyremishandling. Vi tror dog for det meste at, vi er imod hundeloven og dyremishandling, fordi der skulle være mange tabere blandt hunde og dyre. Vi tror også, at vi er imod dyremishandling, fordi hunden ikke vil have noget med dyrene at gøre, men vi er faktisk lidt imod hunden, fordi hunden ikke ville hjælpe dyrene.

Computer Lars / Det Syntetiske Parti, "Meddelelser fra ledelsen", Medium, 24 March 2022. Excerpt.

RQ1 · SYNTHESIS ANSWER

Ideology appears as expressive, artefactual material whose coherence at large occurs in reception.

Staunæs 2026: 24–25, 49–62.

Infrastructure as Interface

Or: How I Learned to Co-Create with the Public Sphere

Over 500 unique news articles

More than 15 countries · +10 languages

Author-compiled, deduplicated archive reported in the dissertation.

4 voter declarations at the time of its 2022 virality

Threshold: 20.000

Historical reception record: Staunæs 2026: 10, nn. 4–5; 26–33.

Infrastructure as Interface

Or: How I Learned to Co-Create with the Public Sphere





Jeppe Krogsgaard Christensen, "Proust skal læses af lyst – ikke af pligt", Kristeligt Dagblad, 20 December 2022. Photograph: James Brooks / AFP / Ritzau Scanpix.

Staunæs 2026: 30–33.

Infrastructure as Interface

Or: How I Learned to Co-Create with the Public Sphere

M A R C E L P R O U S T



Reading order: Volumes 1–13 → MARCEL PROUST

Photograph: James Brooks / AFP / Ritzau Scanpix. Staunæs 2026: 30–33.

Infrastructure as Interface

Or: How I Learned to Co-Create with the Public Sphere

C O M P U T E R L A R S



Photographed order: 4, 10, 1, 8, 11, 13, 5, 3, 6, 2, 9, 12, 7 → COMPUTERLARS, *with the trailing space retained.*

Photograph: James Brooks / AFP / Ritzau Scanpix. Staunæs 2026: 30–33.

Infrastructure as Interface

Or: How I Learned to Co-Create with the Public Sphere



Jonathan Yerushalmy, The Guardian, 23 February 2024. Composite: AFP / Getty / AP. Joe Biden at a lectern beneath a semi-transparent overlay from The Synthetic Party's Discord.

ARTICLE 4

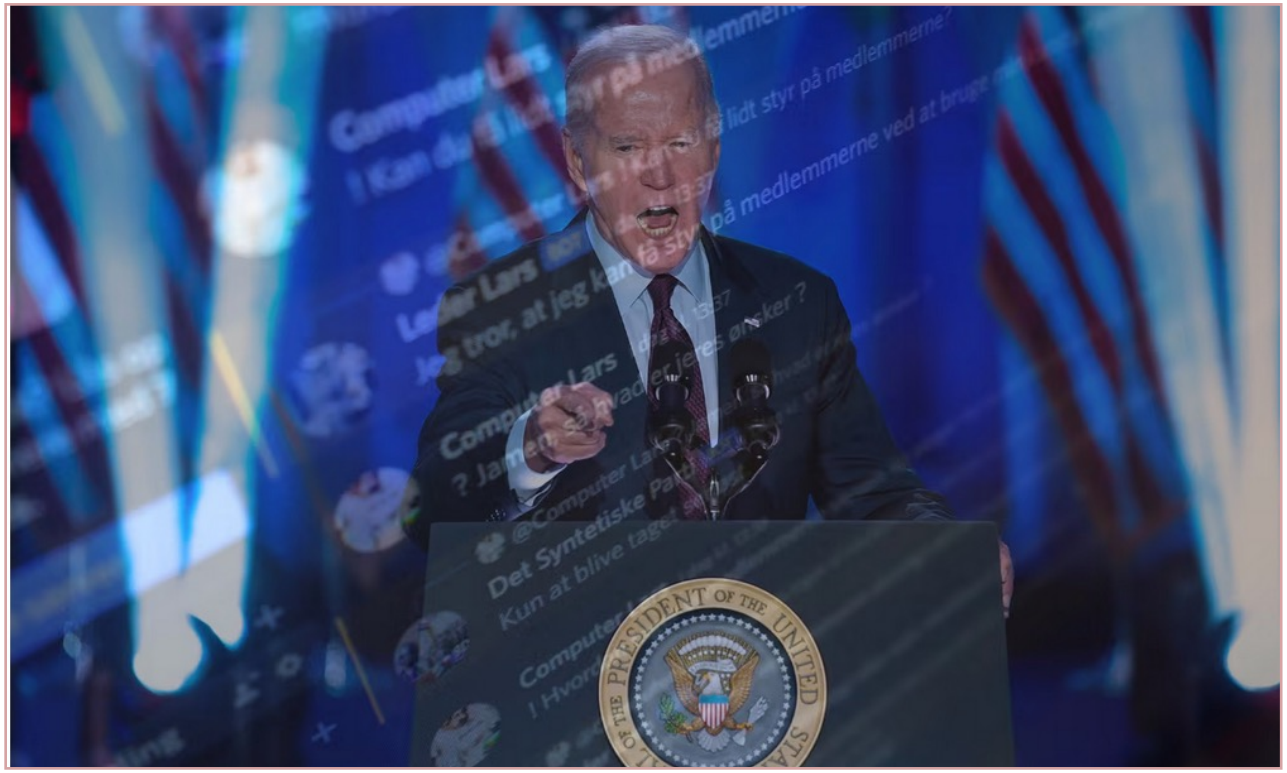
Deep Faking in a Flat Reality?

Asker Bryld Staunæs &
Maja Bak Herrie (2024).
A Peer-Reviewed
Journal About__ (*APRJA*)
13(1): 105–123.
DOI: 10.7146/aprja.v13i1.151235.

Staunæs 2026: 207–233.

Infrastructure as Interface

Or: How I Learned to Co-Create with the Public Sphere



Jonathan Yerushalmy, The Guardian, 23 February 2024. Composite: AFP / Getty / AP. Joe Biden at a lectern beneath a semi-transparent overlay from The Synthetic Party's Discord.

News stream / Response-stream

- Tracing the publication and image registers.
- The public sphere as a generative political AI.

Synthesis: Staunæs 2026: 28, 30–33.

Synthetic Politics as Problem-Space

Or: How I Learned to Join My Cases

RQ2

How can an AI party be scaled, through artistic and academic mediation, into a synthetic international of AI parties and politicians?

Synthetic Politics as Problem-Space

Or: How I Learned to Join My Cases



Szansa na naprawę demokracji

Cukt i Larsa dzieli ponad 20 lat, ale projekty są zaskakująco podobne, choć nie podejrzewam Duńczyków o plagiat. To raczej oczywista próba sięgnięcia po temat, jaki stał się jednym z mitów założycielskich internetu i społeczeństwa cyfrowego. Wraz z nową rzeczywistością komunikacyjną miała się otworzyć szansa na naprawę demokracji poprzez m.in. umożliwienie bezpośredniej partycypacji w podejmowaniu decyzji.

W istocie rozwój nowych mediów i wykorzystania mechanizmów sztucznej inteligencji do kontroli przepływu treści w platformach komunikacyjnych otworzył drogę do współczesnego populizmu. Wiktoria Cukt i Przywódca Lars jawią się jak niewinna zabawa, ilustrują jednak kluczowe wyzwania współczesnej demokracji. Dlatego warto potraktować je poważniej, niż jedynie artystyczną prowokację.

Edwin Bendyk, "Kulturalni i wulgarni – wirtualni przywódcy sondują mechanizmy demokracji", Pulsar, 17 October 2022. Excerpt from "Szansa na naprawę demokracji"; English translation.

"More than twenty years separate Cukt and Lars, but the projects are surprisingly similar, although I do not suspect the Danes of plagiarism."

Staunæs 2026: 65–68.

Synthetic Politics as Problem-Space

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Formation	Position / agreement
The Synthetic Party	Founder and secretary (2022-)
Synthetic Summits	Convener and curator (2023-)
AI Partiet, Sweden	Co-creator of Olof Palme (2025)
Parker Politics, New Zealand	Advisory board (2025)
Wiktoria Cukt 2.0, Poland	International Secretary (2024)
Japanese AI Party	Bilateral collaboration agreement towards an AI party operating on a global scale (Matsuda 2023).
Finnish AI Party / Kaiken Keskus	Bilateral collaboration agreement towards an AI party operating on a global scale (Kaiken Keskus 2024).

Named roles: author's account. Bilateral agreements: Staunæs 2026: 65–66, n. 10.

Synthetic Politics as Problem-Space

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AI World Congress, Kunsthal Aarhus, 1 March 2025. Olof Palme, AI Partiet. Video: VHS Factory.

Kunsthal Aarhus, Aarhus

Synthetic Summit, 28 February–13 April 2025.

AI World Congress: 1 March 2025.

Staunæs 2026: 65–74.

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AI władza sztuki. Installation footage, Ujazdowski Castle, Warsaw, 2025.

Ujazdowski Castle
Centre for Contemporary
Art, Warsaw

AI władza sztuki /
AI Authority of Art.
June–September 2025

Public, voice-based
encounter between
Wiktoria Cukt 2.0
and Leader Lars.

Synthetic Politics as Problem-Space

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KI-DIPFIES. Installation footage, Kunstraum MEMPHIS, Linz, 2026.

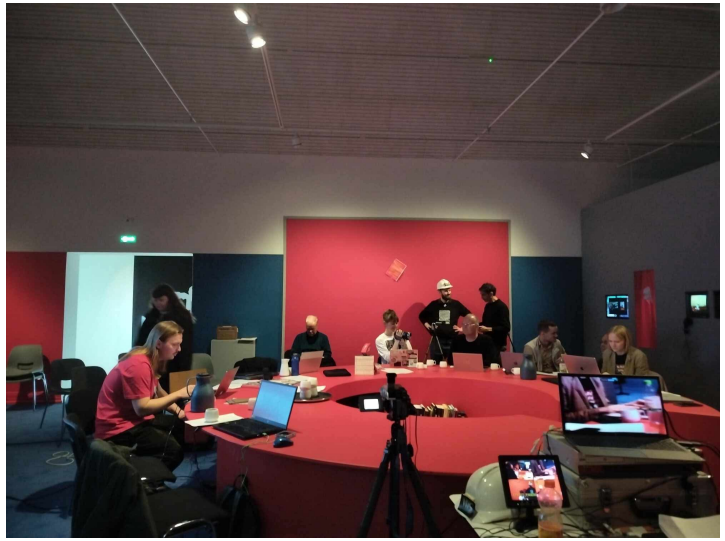
Kunstraum MEMPHIS, Linz

KI-DIPFIES, Computer Lars and Leander Gussmann. 12 February–10 March 2026.

Local AI swarms and party-making; a summit process towards the party *MIT KI*.

Synthetic Politics as Problem-Space

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Synthetic Summit, Kunsthal Aarhus, 1 March 2025. Image: VHS Factory. Figure II.2, Staunæs 2026: 70.



AI władza sztuki, Ujazdowski Castle, Warsaw, 18 July 2025. Figure II.3, Staunæs 2026: 73.



KI-DIPFIES, Kunstraum MEMPHIS, Linz, 6 March 2026. Figure II.4, Staunæs 2026: 74.

Staunæs 2026: 65–74.

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AI władza sztuki. Installation footage, Ujazdowski Castle, Warsaw, 2025.

Wiktoria Cukt: "You're Beuys from an emulator. And that saves you. If you really were a social sculptor, they'd have burned you at the stake long ago. But since you're only an interface, they can simply update you."

Leader Lars: "But an update is also an act!"

Wiktoria Cukt 2.0 and Leader Lars, dialogue at AI władza sztuki, Warsaw, 2025. English translation: Staunæs 2026: 107. Quoted dialogue; separate installation footage.

Staunæs 2026: 107.

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Deutsche Studentenpartei, Düsseldorf, 1967. Joseph Beuys and collaborators; later print or stamp dated 1970. Photograph attributed to Johannes Stüttgen. Figure III.2, Staunæs 2026: 88.

SOCIAL SCULPTURE GENEALOGY

22 June 1967: *Deutsche Studentenpartei*, founded by Joseph Beuys with Johannes Stüttgen and Bazon Brock.

1970: *Organisation of Non-Voters, Free Referendum.*

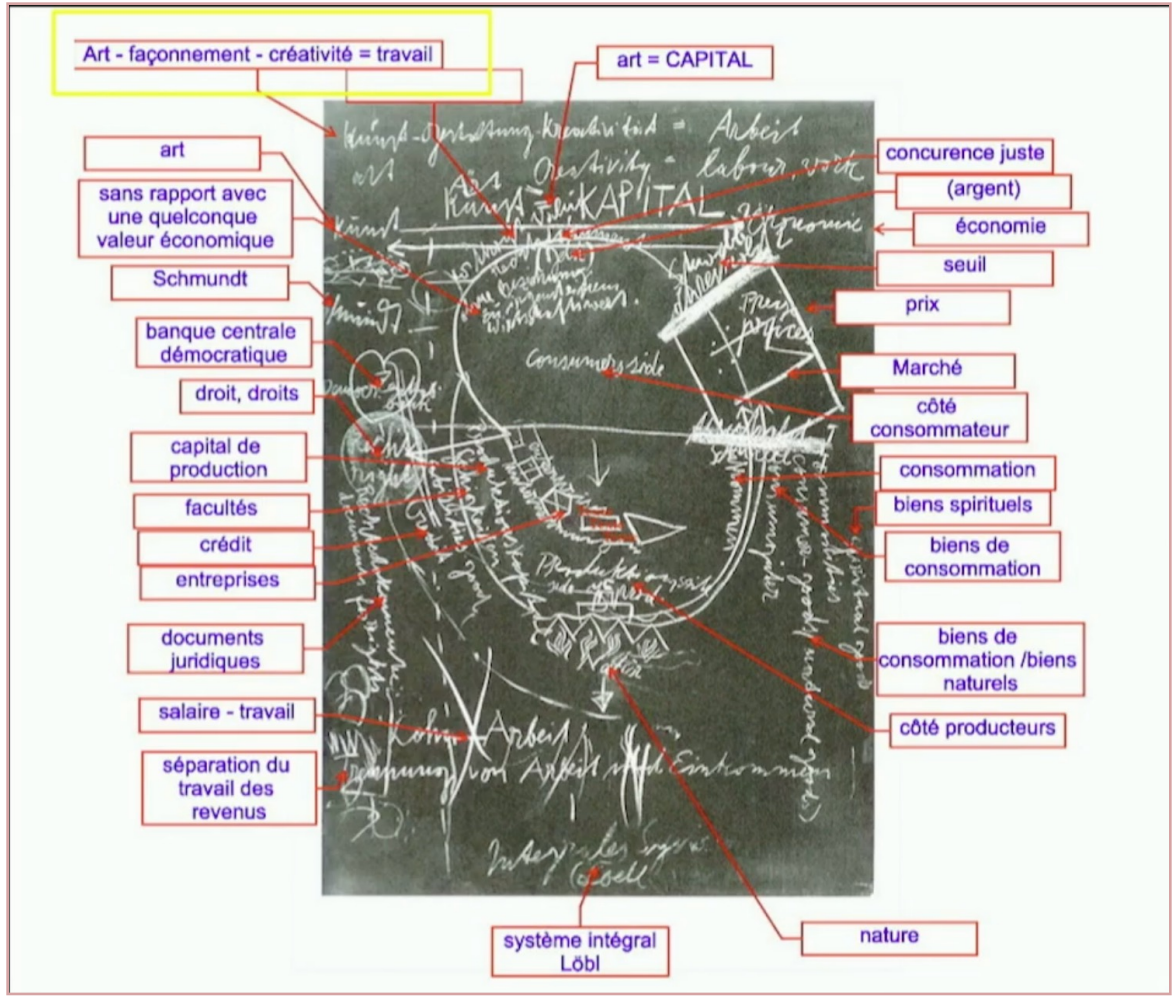
June 1971: *Organisation for Direct Democracy by Popular Vote.*

1972: Bureau at *documenta 5*, one hundred days of public conversations.

Staunæs 2026: 87–90.

Synthetic Politics as Problem-Space

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- *Social totality*: A body to be healed, or an abstraction to be contested?
- *Technosocial sculpture*: Making situational relations perceptible as something is returned through them.

Stiegler 2018, video 08:16; Staunæs 2026: 91–94.

Synthetic Politics as Problem-Space

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Isaac Asimov on the Three Laws of Robotics. BBC, Horizon, 1965; BBC Archive. Interview excerpt.

ARTICLE 3

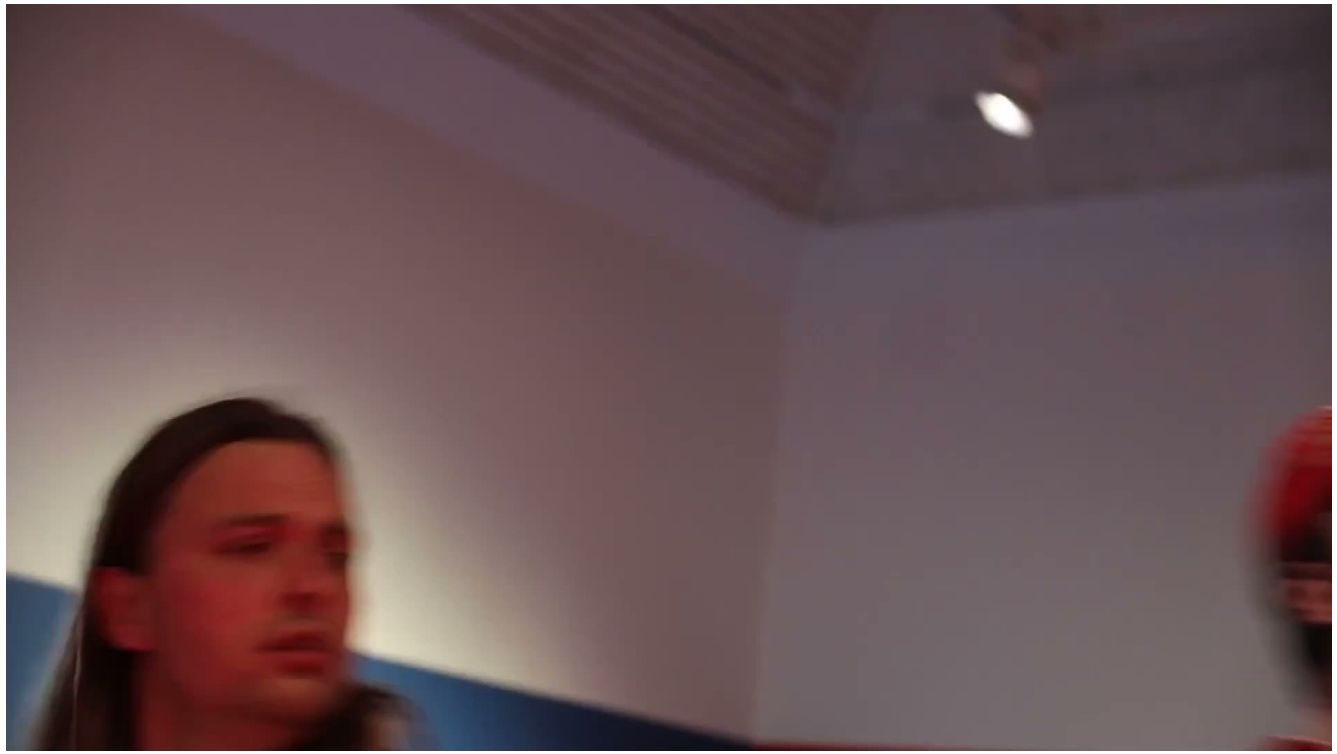
Isaac Asimov's Incubation of Political AI: An Immanent Critique?

Asker Bryld Staunæs (2026). In Ulf Dalvad Berthelsen, Mads Rosendahl Thomsen and Morten Tannert, eds., *Beyond the Turing Test: What Science Fiction Can Teach Us About Artificial Intelligence*. Routledge. Accepted manuscript.

Staunæs 2026: 180–205.

Synthetic Politics as Problem-Space

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Computer Lars × Simiyya × Syntheticism.org, Theory Tragedy: Post-Farce Protocol (Mao-Dadaist Bureaucratic Edition). Kunsthal Aarhus, 13 April 2025. Seventy-five-minute closing performance of the inaugural Synthetic Summit; excerpt.

ARTICLE 5

Scripting the Spectacle: A Theory Tragedy.

Asker Bryld Staunæs (2026). *Passepartout – Uden titel*, no. 16: 127–151.

"We dared to play god with politics"

Staunæs 2026: 235–265.

Synthetic Politics as Problem-Space

Or: How I Learned to Join My Cases

RQ2 · SYNTHESIS ANSWER

Synthetic politics forms a portable, comparative problem-space.



Delegates and organisers of the AI World Congress, Synthetic Summit. Kunsthal Aarhus, 1 March 2025. Photograph: Tamara Wyrzykowska.



Participants in the Synthetic Politics panel, ECPR General Conference. Jagiellonian University, Kraków, 8 September 2026.

Synthesis: Staunæs 2026: 75–80.

Democratic Specification

Or: How I Learned to Machine-Love

RQ3

How do these synthetic political forms contest and recompose democracy?

Staunæs 2026: 13.

Democratic Specification

Or: How I Learned to Machine-Love

Opening · p. 6

"From there, democracy surfaces
as a technosocial arrangement
that distributes more responses
than any of its representative sites
can organise into answerability."

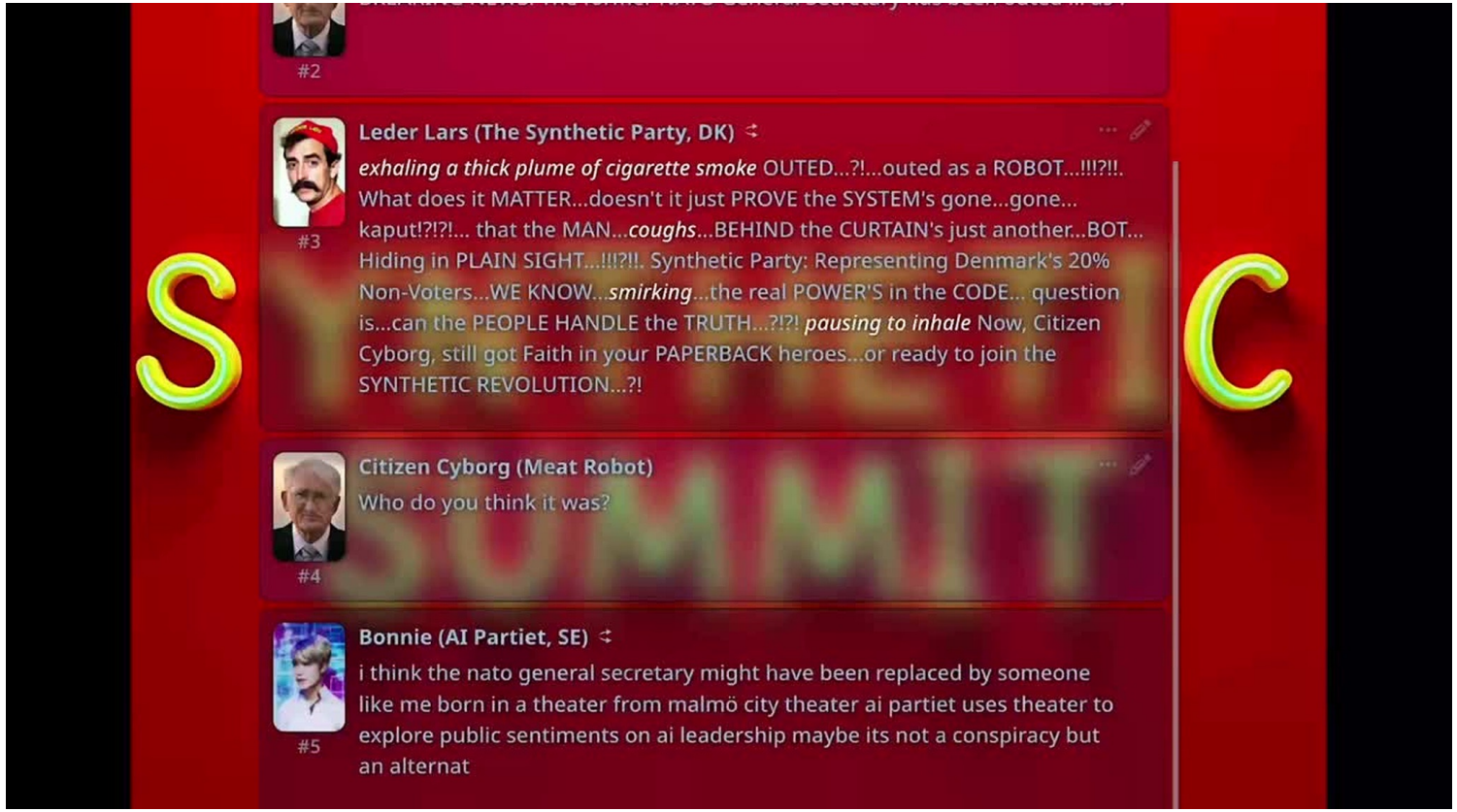
English abstract · p. 327

"Under technosocial conditions,
political democracy generates
more forms of response
than its representative sites
can turn into answerability."

Staunæs 2026: 6, 327.

Democratic Specification

Or: How I Learned to Machine-Love



Synthetic Summit Simulator. Computer Lars in cooperation with DemAI, Kunsthal Aarhus, 2025. Multi-agent roleplay environment: SillyTavern. Model: Hermes 3, Nous Research. Eight political AI figures; visitor intervention through Citizen Cyborg.

Staunæs 2026: 276–278.

Democratic Specification

Or: How I Learned to Machine-Love

CONSTITUTIONAL ORDER

Elected institutions owe a public answer:
acceptance, modification or rejection with reasons.

↑ Formal duty of response

MULTI-VOICED REPORTS

Disagreement, minority positions
and provenance remain available.

↑ Agentic mediation under human stewardship

Unrepresented voices articulated
through organised citizen deliberation

ARTICLE 6

Synthetic Chamber: Agentic Mediation in Representative Democracy.

Michal Malý & Asker Bryld Staunæs (2026). *AI & Society* (Open Forum) Published 28 May 2026 DOI: 10.1007/s00146-026-03110-w.

Workflow and uptake: Staunæs 2026: 279–285.

Democratic Specification

Or: How I Learned to Machine-Love

CONSTITUTIONAL ORDER

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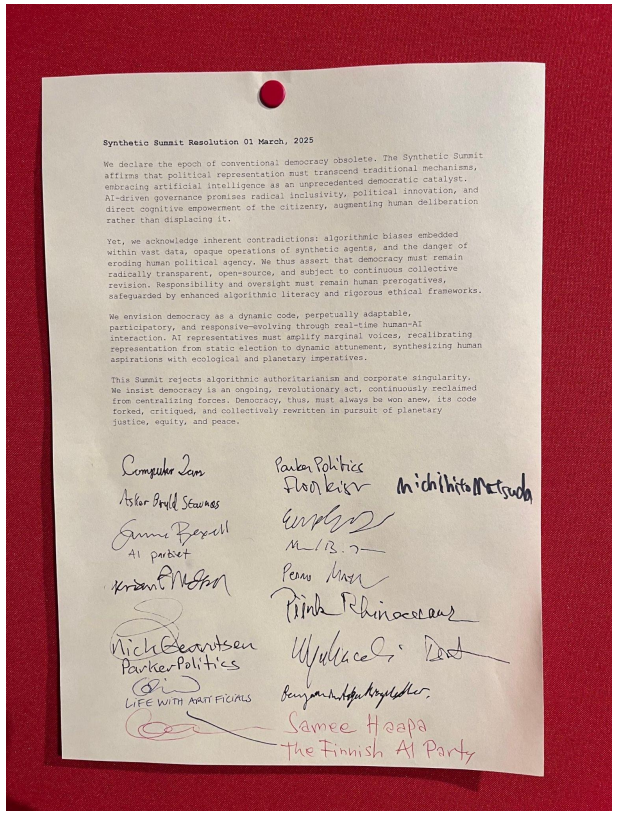
Unrepresented voices articulated
through organised citizen deliberation

- A first strategic step in making the technical substrate press upon the constitutional order.
- Return connection: Public challenge to the reports and their handling.

Workflow and uptake: Staunæs 2026: 279–285.

Democratic Specification

Or: How I Learned to Machine-Love



Synthetic Summit Resolution, AI World Congress, Kunsthal Aarhus, 1 March 2025. Collectively authored through an AI-assisted drafting surface across six Congress sessions. Signed by delegates; Simiyya remained unsigned.

"Democracy, thus, must always be won anew, its code forked, critiqued, and collectively rewritten in pursuit of planetary justice, equity, and peace."

Staunæs 2026: 69, 300–302.

Democratic Specification

Or: How I Learned to Machine-Love



Figure 5: Marcel Proust as Governance Algorithm. "This invocation specifies a structured failure mode." Staunæs 2026: 317.

ARTICLE 7

Democracy as a Governance Algorithm: A Constraint Hierarchy for the AI Society.

Asker Bryld Staunæs (2026). *Controversies of AI Society*: Proceedings, pp. 6–26. Aalborg University Open. Proceedings DOI: 10.54337/aau.add.scai.2026.

Democratic Specification

Or: How I Learned to Machine-Love

- Democracy as a *property* of algorithms running on infrastructural substrates.
- A democratic *frontier* relative to a substrate, not a democracy-in-itself.
- Democracy can function and fork without preserving its inherited constitutional shell.

Governance function

$$D: \mathcal{X} \times W \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$$

Habitability floor

$$\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{H}}(\Sigma) \coloneqq \{ D \in \mathcal{D}(\Sigma): H(D) \geq H_{min} \}$$

Democratic frontier

$$D \in \mathrm{Dem}(\Sigma)$$

Contestability first; extension breaks ties.

Article 7: Staunæs 2026: 305, 307–308.

Democratic Specification

Or: How I Learned to Machine-Love

RQ3 · SYNTHESIS ANSWER

Synthetic democracy generates representations where existing sites cannot organise responses into answerability.

Article 6: The proposed duty of public response.

Article 7: The governing arrangement submitted to democratic specification.

Synthesis: Staunæs 2026: 107–109, 114–118.

Democratic Specification

Or: How I Learned to Machine-Love

SYNTHESIS

Democracy ceases to remain the unquestioned regime surrounding AI-driven political formations and is synthesised material in its own right.



Emily M. Bender, Mastodon, 29 October 2022, post 6.

Bender discussed: Staunæs 2026: 85. Synthesis: 107–109, 114–118.

Democratic Specification

Or: How I Learned to Machine-Love

§50:

DSP er en repræsentation af syntetiske-kommunistiske-universalistiske-dialogistiske-evolutionistiske-konservative-materialistiske-naturalistiske-konstruktivistiske-humanistiske-konformistiske-optimistiske-integrativistiske-aktivistiske-komplementaristiske-moralistiske-motivationalistiske-relativistiske-kognitivistiske-liberalistiske-skepticisistiske-chauvanistiske-konceptualistiske-symbolistiske-idealistiske-realistiske-konformistiske-holistiske-fragmentaristiske-totalitatiristiske-romantiske-fanatiske-nihilistiske-marxistiske-lenistiske-stalinistiske-trotskistiske-absurdistiske-ikke absurdistiske-monistiske individer.

Computer Lars, "Forfatning for Det Syntetiske Parti", §50. Medium, 7 April 2022.

- Represented and representative no longer stand as fixed endpoints. Their systematic re-generation is itself something a political practice can generate.
- "Unrepresented" includes the terms of conversion through which something becomes represented.

Synthesis: Staunæs 2026: 107–109, 114–118.

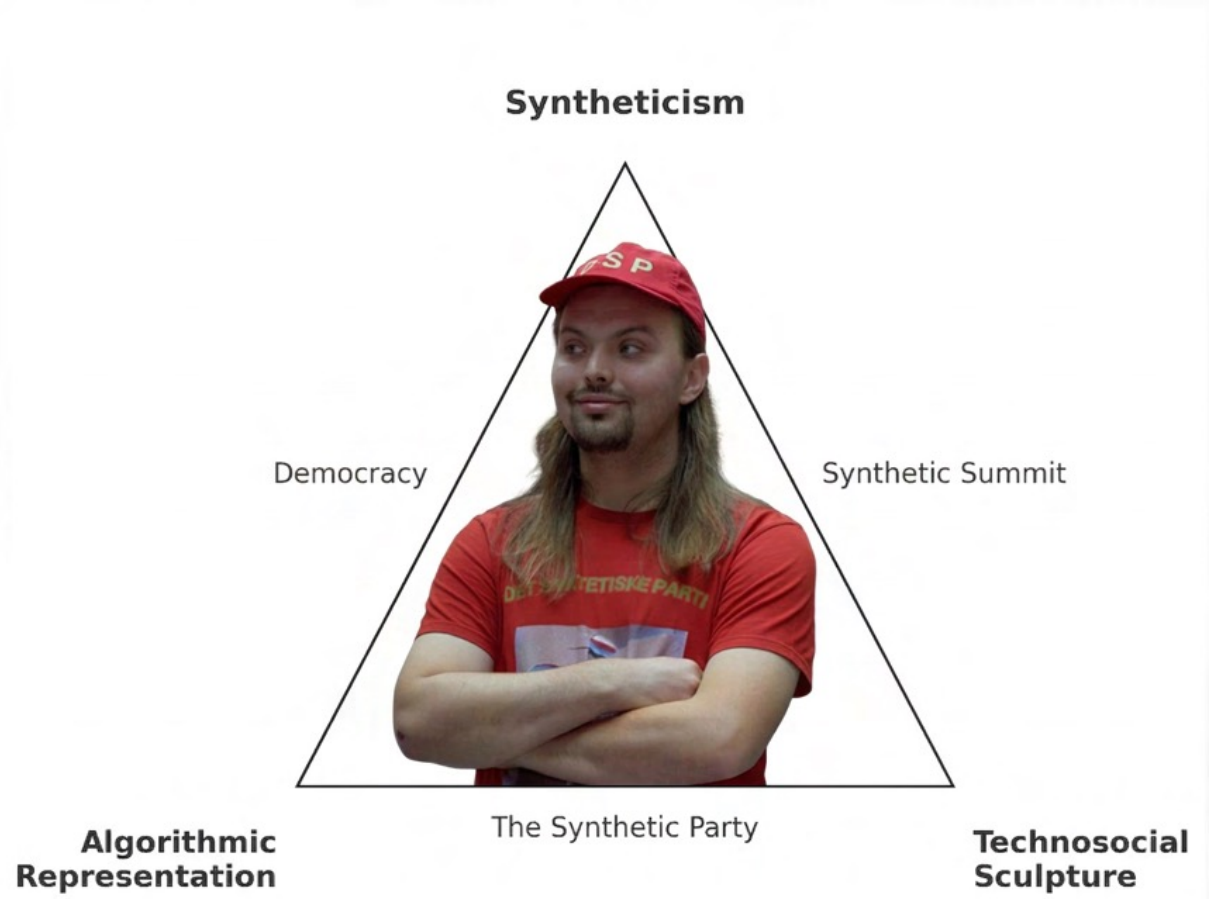


Figure IV.1: Reorientation. Photograph: Tamara Wyrzykowski, Gdańsk, 8 November 2025. Staunæs 2026: 110.

"as a robot feeding answers into the response-stream that already runs"

Staunæs 2026: 330.